
Appealing a Special Needs Assistance for Seniors decision

Alberta | Special Needs Assistance for Seniors | Built 2 October 2026

This packet helps you appeal a Special Needs Assistance for Seniors decision.

The program uses three steps. You must do them in order. Each step is a separate letter.

Step 3 uses a form called a Notice of Appeal. You cannot download it. The program mails it to you only after you finish Step 2. So Steps 1 and 2 are where you build your case.

Fill in what you can. Leave the rest blank. A short letter still counts.

This packet is not legal advice. It is a way to put your own appeal in writing.

What the rules say

The rule is section 9 of the Seniors Benefit Act General Regulation, AR 213/94.

You can appeal two things: whether you qualify, and how much you were paid.

The appeal goes in writing to the Minister.

The Minister may send your appeal to a panel of up to three people. The word is may, not must.

Only the panel can pay you back for more than 11 months. The rule is section 9(2)(d).

The panel's decision is final. The rule is section 9(4).

There is also section 8.2. It lets the Minister pay up to \$5,000 for a senior who cannot meet the necessities of life. The regulation says \$5,000 in each year. The program page calls it one-time. If this may apply to you, name section 8.2 in your letter.

Why this packet exists

Step 3 uses a form the program will not publish. It is mailed to you only after Step 2 is finished. That is why this packet puts your whole case in writing at Steps 1 and 2. Your written appeal stands on its own.

If you need help

Alberta Supports Contact Centre: 1-877-644-9992. Monday to Friday, 7:30 am to 8 pm. Fax: 780-422-5954.

Step 1. Letter of appeal

Send this to:
Director, Seniors Financial Assistance
Special Needs Assistance for Seniors
PO Box 3100, Edmonton, Alberta T5J 4W3
Fax: 780-422-5954
Or upload it through Submit documents online.

YOUR FULL NAME

YOUR CLIENT OR FILE NUMBER, IF YOU HAVE ONE

How you were told

How you were told matters. The program says it will send you a letter with the decision, the law it was made under, the evidence it looked at, and the reasons. If you were told by phone and nothing came in the mail, say so. That is part of your appeal.

- ☐ I got the decision in writing.
- ☐ I was told by phone or in person. Nothing came in writing.

DATE ON THE LETTER, OR THE DATE YOU WERE TOLD

WHO TOLD YOU, BY NAME OR JOB TITLE

WHAT THE DECISION SAID

WHAT YOU ASKED THE PROGRAM TO PAY FOR

WHY YOU DISAGREE

WHAT THIS DECISION COSTS YOU

WHAT YOU ARE ATTACHING

I am asking the director to consider section 8.2, the necessities benefit, up to \$5,000.

If you need more room, use a separate sheet. Put your name at the top of it.

YOUR SIGNATURE

DATE YOU SIGNED

DATE YOU SENT THIS

Write the date you send this. The date you send matters more than the date you sign.

What you should get back

The program says its letter will tell you four things: the decision, the law it was made under, the evidence it looked at, and the reasons.

If any of those four are missing, say so in Step 2. Keep this page.

Step 2. Request a final review

Send this to:

Assistant Deputy Minister, Seniors Division

PO Box 3100, Edmonton, Alberta T5J 4W3

Fax: 780-422-5954

Or upload it through Submit documents online.

YOUR FULL NAME

DATE OF THE DIRECTOR'S DECISION

Check what the Step 1 letter gave you

Tick what the Step 1 letter gave you. If no letter ever came, tick the last box instead and say so in your own words below. A missing letter is a reason to appeal on its own.

- ☐ I was given the decision itself
- ☐ I was given the law it was decided under
- ☐ I was given the evidence that was considered
- ☐ I was given the reasons for the decision
- ☐ No letter ever came

WHAT IS STILL UNRESOLVED

ANYTHING NEW SINCE STEP 1

WHAT YOU WANT TO HAPPEN

If you need more room, use a separate sheet. Put your name at the top of it.

YOUR SIGNATURE

DATE YOU SIGNED

DATE YOU SENT THIS

Step 3. Your record, and what to ask the panel

Keep dates here. If the Notice of Appeal form does not arrive, these dates are your proof.

DATE YOU SENT THE FINAL REVIEW

DATE THE ANSWER CAME BACK

DATE THE NOTICE OF APPEAL FORM CAME

PHONE AND MAIL LOG

What to put on the Notice of Appeal when it comes

Ask for the appeal to go to a panel. Section 9(2) lets the Minister send it there.

If you were paid late, ask the panel to go back more than 11 months. Only the panel can do this. The rule is section 9(2)(d).

Name section 8.2 if you cannot meet the necessities of life.

Attach this packet. It is your written appeal already.

If you believe a particular person handled your file wrongly, write that in your own words in the box below. Keep it to what you saw or were told, and give dates. Do not guess at why.

IN YOUR OWN WORDS

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